

Dehradun, Hyatt Place Hampi along with city hotels such as Park Hyatt Chennai and Andaz Delhi, among others, are pet friendly.

As Singh checked into Hyatt Regency Dehradun with Lolita she was escorted to her room where a bed, food and water bowls and some treats and toys were already placed to make Lolita comfortable. The hotel charges ₹2,500 as a one-time fee for deep cleaning and sanitisation. "The hotel has vast open spaces and their staff is dog-loving. They even prepared Lolita's meals the way she is used to eating them at home," says Singh, adding that it turned out to be a great holiday for her as she could relax in the spa, knowing that Lolita was comfortable in the room.

114 | At IHCL, all their SeleQtions and amā Stays & Trails properties along with select Taj and Vivanta hotels are pet friendly. "In fact, our SeleQtions hotels saw an increasing demand from guests travelling with their pets and has introduced a special 'Pawcations' offer across its hotels. Select hotels offer meals, a hi-tea experience and outdoor activities for your furry friend under this package," says an IHCL spokesperson. The 'Pawcations' package was launched in 2020. The team across SeleQtions has also been well sensitised on how to interact with pets and pet owners, to understand pet body language and address questions and concerns that may arise, says the spokesperson. As part of this, IHCL SeleQtions recently held a one-day symposium aimed at helping patrons decode the pet language.

India's pet care market is expected to grow to ₹7,500 crore by the end of 2026, on account of rising nuclear families, double-income households, change in lifestyle, urbanisation, and increasing pet ownership, according to a report by Bonafide Research.

Nearly all these are reasons for more people travelling with their



pets. Nuclear families mean there are fewer options to leave pets behind. Also, the pandemic resulted in more people undertaking driving holidays, making it that much easier to travel with pets. "There has been an exponential increase in the number of pet families that have been checking in, particularly in the past couple of years. One of the impacts of the pandemic is that there was a huge increase in the number of people taking road trips, which then allowed a lot of families to travel with their pets, and hence look for pet-friendly accommodation," says a spokesperson from Lemon Tree Hotels; the chain has three pet-friendly hotels

in Coorg, Goa, and Manesar.

While ITC Hotels launched their 'Petcation' initiative a few years ago, they too have seen an increase in demand post the pandemic. "Post the pandemic, many travellers are seeking destinations that allow pet stays. Everyone wants to enjoy a vacation and the pleasure of having their pets with them really multiplies their joy, besides giving them worry-free stays that they may not have experienced earlier leaving their pets at home," says Anil Chadha, Divisional Chief Executive-ITC Hotels. Welcomhotels at leisure destinations such as Amritsar, Shimla and Jodhpur are pet friendly, along with ITC Grand